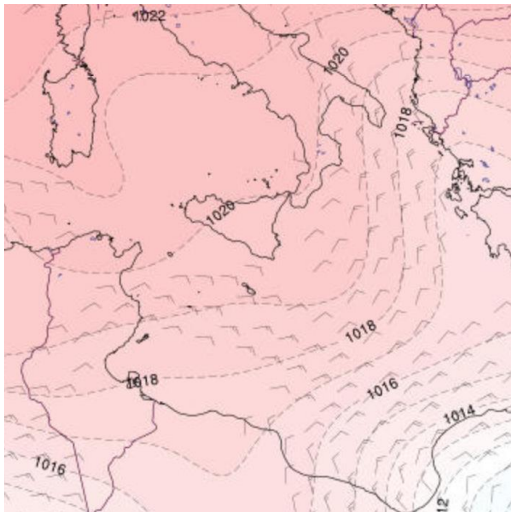


Date: October 18th , 2018
Time: 09:50 AM (07:50 UTC)
Event: Middle Sea Race
Team: Power Play

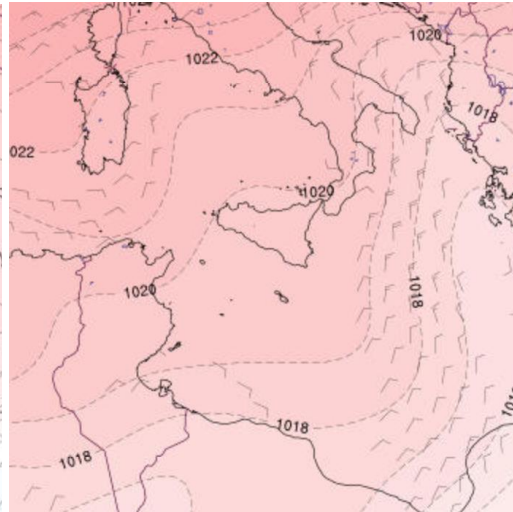


Synopsis: Steady High-pressure belt from the British Isles to eastern Europe. Low pressures around Turkey and eastern Med, weak on the weekend but deepening and moving closer on Monday and Tuesday.

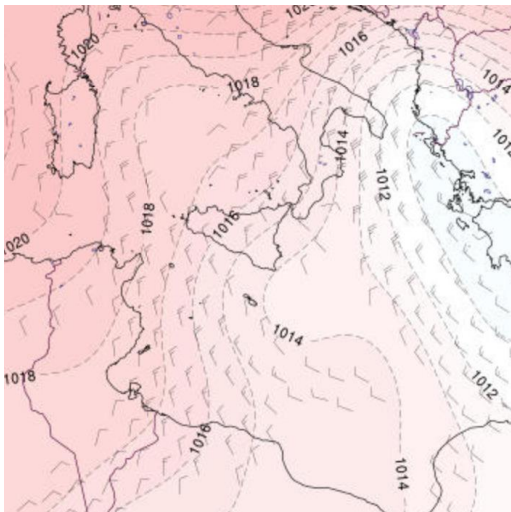
In terms of wind, this leads to a quite slow first leg up to Messina, with light gradient, maybe playing with local winds, then the northerly gradient will fill in moderate to fresh.



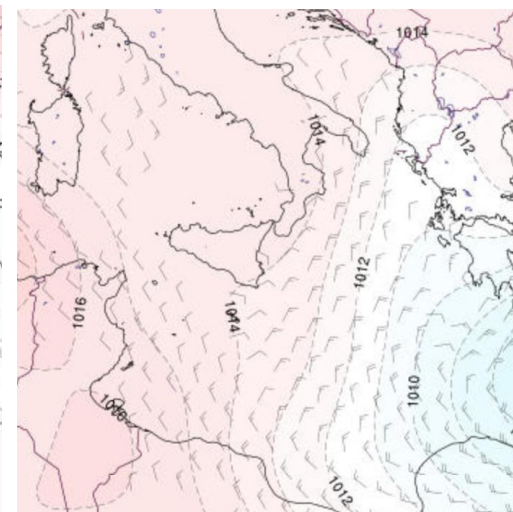
SLP FCST valid 12 utc Sat 20th



SLP FCST valid 12 utc Sun 21st



SLP FCST valid 12 utc Mon 22nd



SLP FCST valid 12 utc Tue 23rd

WARNINGS: Nil.

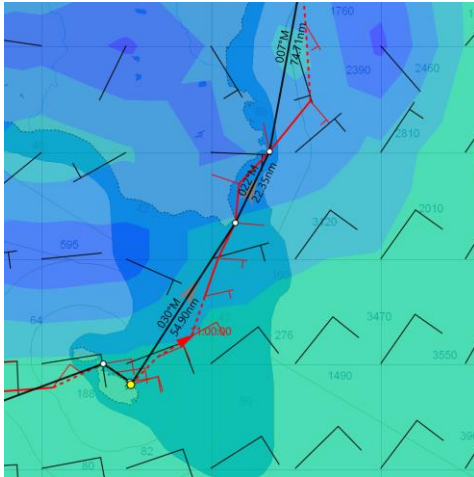
Weather Conditions: Quite stable atmosphere, mostly sunny sky most of the time, slight chance of a shower on the Messina-Stromboli leg with the wind convergences. Sea Surface Temperature around 22° C.

Forecast along the course

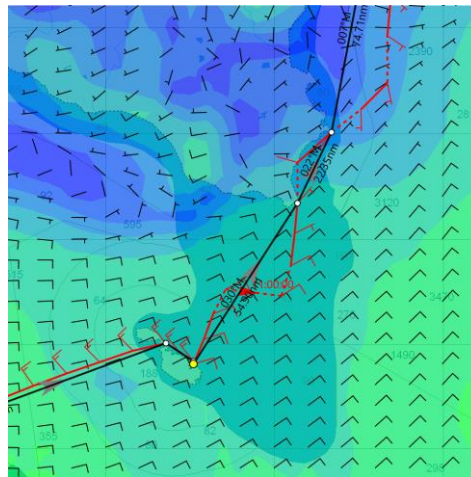
Let's run by the moment the routings with GFS and with the first hours with Arpege.

Malta to Capo Passero and Siracusa

Some initial gradient from the NE, veering a bit in the afternoon with the Sicilian Thermal, but dying in the evening/early night with the night cooling. So initially gentle/moderate breeze from NE-110° 6-10 kts, a fetch or a beat mainly on Starboard, veering and dropping before reaching Capo Passero. Possible very light and variable period close to Capo Passero, we'll see the drainage breezes from Capo Passero to Siracusa.



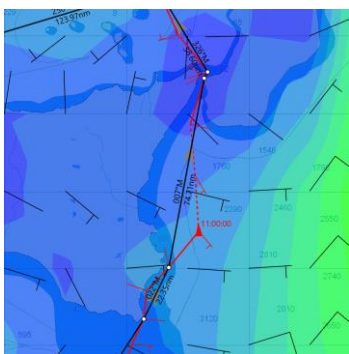
GFS 14 h



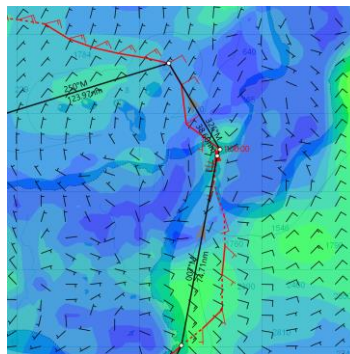
Arpege 14 h

Capo Passero to Messina Strait

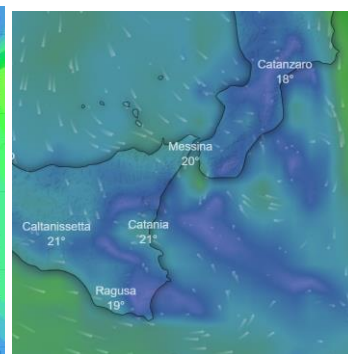
The northerly gradient apparently remains to the West, drainage breezes close to the shores. We'll have to decide between them. On Sunday, the Sicilian thermal effect can pull the gradient as an Easterly breeze during central hours, strongly bending as S into the Strait in the evening. EC scenario, however, is quite different by the moment, light and variable gradient to the W, Northerly gradient reaching the Strait from the Tyrrhenian...



GFS Sun 11 h



Arpege 17 h



EC 17 h

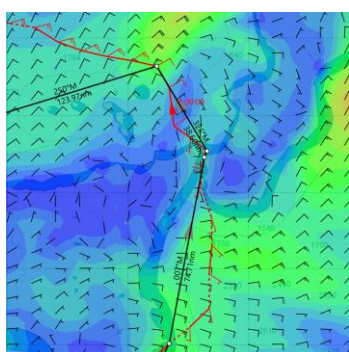
GFS routing is very slow, crossing Messina Strait around midnight, in this case against the current. But Arpege routing is much faster, an offshore course finds some easterly gradient, then it can cross the Strait with the current around 16-17 h.

Northwards current (*montante*) between 1240 and 1840 h. (Sunday 21st)
Southwards current (*scendente*) between 1840 h and 0125 h
Northwards current (*montante*) between 0125 and 0710 h. (Monday 22nd)

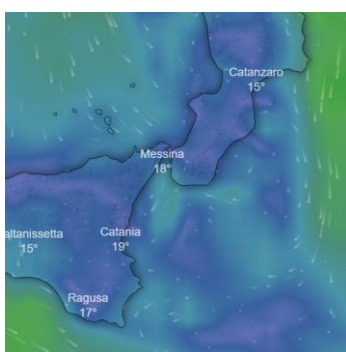
As we can see, this first part of the race can be quite critical, small timing differences can mean you face a the *Montante* o *scendente* causing huge differences.

Strait to Stromboli

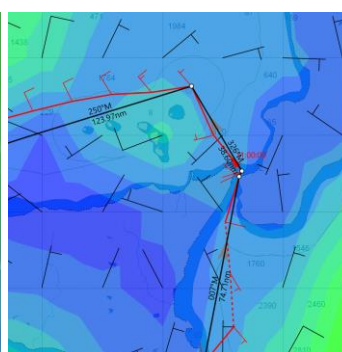
Arpege shows a transition from the Southerly wind in the Strait to the northerly gradient at Stromboli. GFS routing shows crossing the strait around midnight, (not a god timing with the current by the moment). So, from the Strait to Stromboli, we don't have any reliable defined pattern, we'll have to wait for the last runs and hires models.



Arpege 20 h



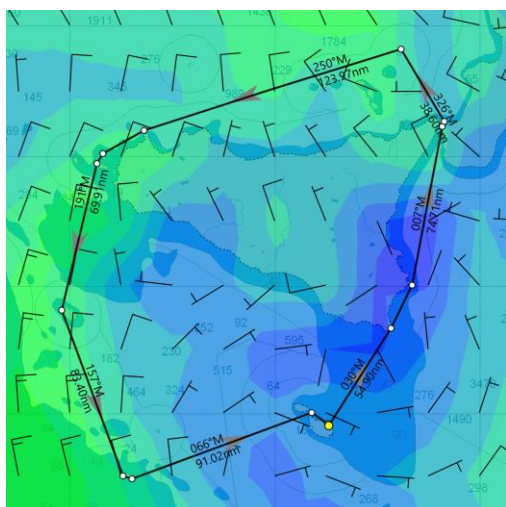
ECMWF 20 h



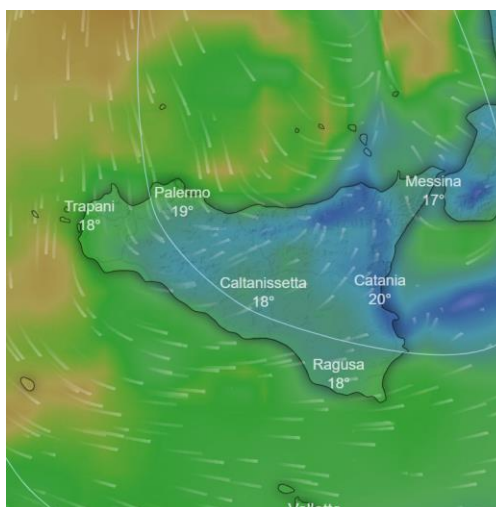
GFS 05 h Monday

Stromboli to Finish

Too far ahead, and too big timing differences from this point onwards, so let's have just a Big Picture. The Northerly gradient is expected to fill in all over north of Sicily on Sunday night or Monday, and moderate to fresh breezes are expected from NW at least up to Lampedusa.

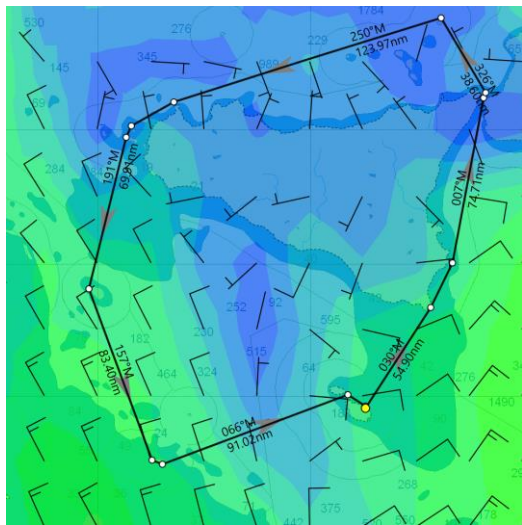


GFS Monday 14 h

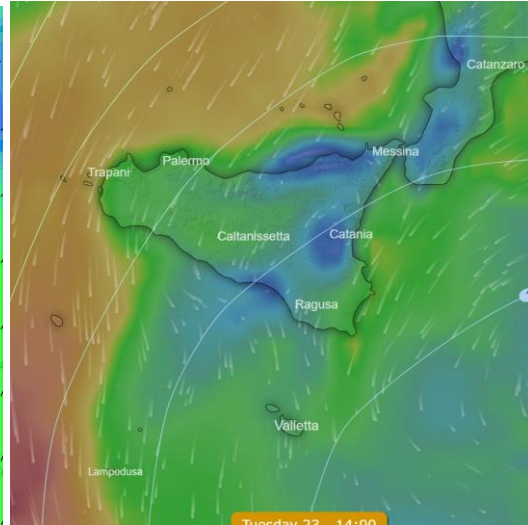


EC Monday 14 h

Both models agree on Low pressures developing on the Central Mediterranean on Tuesday can lead to N/NE gradient, what can mean N to the W of Sicily, NE to the E, and a transition zone between both pattern (the island shadow) in the middle. Too far ahead, though...



GFS Tue 14 h



EC Tue 14 h

Summary:

Models are very inconsistent just after capo Passero, but we can get the Big Picture, some initial beat in gentle breezes, then light and tricky to cross east of Sicily. The pattern and timing for the Strait and onwards will be more defined in the next model runs, but all models are consistent on an increasing breeze from Stromboli to the end, mainly from N and W, possibly tricky again in the end.